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Computer Studies Extension Office

I. PROJECT TITLE:

Promote Information and Communications Technology Undertaking Research and Extension Services (**PICTURES**) Integration to Agriculture and Aquaculture Technology Business Incubator (**ATBI**) Project

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III. RATIONALE

ICT is one of the economic development pillars to gain national competitive advantage. It can improve the quality of human life because it can be used as a learning and education media. Its importance in people's lives and it is expected that this trend will continue to the extent that ICT literacy will become a functional requirement for people's work, social and personal lives. (<https://pcdreams.com.sg/importance-of-information-and-communications-technology-ict-in-our-daily-life/>).

Nearly all (98.5%) of the 3,721 Information Economy (IE) establishments covered in the 2015 Survey on Information and Communication Technology (SICT) used computer and other hardware in their business operations. Content and Media sector had the highest usage of 99.0 percent which was slightly higher than the 98.3 percent usage for the ICT

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sector. All establishments under the following industries used computers and other hardware such as ICT manufacturing industries, Software publishing, Data processing, hosting and related activities; web portals and Publishing activities. (Source: Philippine Statistics Authority 2015 Survey on Information and Communication Technology - Information Economy - Preliminary Results, released August 23, 2018). (<https://psa.gov.ph/content/2015-survey-information-and-communication-technology-information-economy-preliminary-results>).

CapSU Dayao Satellite College Computer Studies Department research and extension banner program Promote Information and Communications Technology Undertaking Research and Extension Services (PICTURES) provide different trainings that can enhance communities productivity and business starters under the Agri-Aqua Technology Business Incubator in terms of creating insights from data leading to better decision making; and using multiple digital platforms to promote products and services to reach wider potential customers..

IV. OBJECTIVES

1. Provide relevant seminars, webinars and trainings workshops under the PICTURES (Promote Information and Communication Technology Undertaking Research and Extension Services) Project to ATBI incubatees;
2. Provide faculty experts as resource persons and consultants;
3. Assist clientele to make product designs and labels;
4. Facilitate the online promotion of the products.

V. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

PICTURES banner research and extension program educated individuals particularly incubatees equipped them with the necessary knowledge and skills in terms of digital technology. Incubatees primarily concerned was how to promote their business online and to attract potential customers with less or no money spending for advertising. Most start up business were limited in financial resources, they also struggled technically since majority were not technically savvy.

The Agri Aqua Technology Business Incubator Center through the partnership with the Computer Studies Department, integrated PICTURES. The incubatees were catered, attended the Digital Marketing (one of the trainings under the PICTURES) and able to developed business pages and sites as well as digital stores to promote and accept orders online. The use of Point of Sales was also introduced. By using engaging technical tool to reach potential customers such as Facebook Page, Google Sites and Peddlr App. These free online platforms were easy to understand drag-and-drop and

results can be viewed immediately. Sharing of online store links via pages, sites, messenger were easily facilitated.

The participants were the incubatees and their families with basic backgrounds on the use of digital platforms. They attended the webinar training, understood the different digital marketing platforms, Search Engine Optimization (SEO), organic and inorganic listings and many more. They were able to present a Facebook page and a Google Site applying the concepts of optimization to rank their site/page high. The page/site created advertise the association quality products that can compete with other localities and regions.

VI. RESULTS OF INTERVENTIONS

The participants gained knowledge and skills on how to engage in Digital Marketing. The use of multiple digital marketing platforms gave the incubatees additional promotions, increased the volume of traffics, from views to inquiries and orders as well as feedbacks made to the page and site.

VII. LESSONS LEARNED

Engaging in Digital Marketing increased the customer's reach. The challenge was that most of the incubatees were not technically skillful and knowledgeable. This prompted the modification of the training design. It was suggested to include members of the family or friends that can greatly help in developing and maintaining pages, sites and online stores. Facilitators of the training were also requested to join the Digital Marketing training.

VIII. RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the lessons learned and the assessment of the performance of the participants output, the following recommendations are:

1. Digital Literacy of the incubatees shall be assessed prior the actual trainings.
2. Training modules in Digital Marketing and related trainings must be developed.
3. Incubatees may undergo training on Basic Photography.